Payments, Billing Corrections and Transaction Complaints

Document ID: MP-PAY | Merchant: MaplePaw Pet Supply Canada | Version: 1.0

Effective date: 2026-10-08 | Region: Fictional Canadian storefront | Currency: CAD

Document status: Original synthetic merchant policy for software testing.

This document contains invented merchant operating rules for payment reconciliation and complaint handling. It covers topics that public retail policies may not expressly address. It does not describe Chewy's transaction procedures, give official PayPal evidence requirements, or guarantee any external dispute result.

Contents

MP-PAY-01. Accepted payment routes and ledger ownership

MP-PAY-02. Authorization, capture and split shipment accounting

MP-PAY-03. Pending holds and cancelled orders

MP-PAY-04. Unrecognized or unauthorized transactions

MP-PAY-05. Refund not received or credit not processed

MP-PAY-06. Multiple entries that are not confirmed duplicates

MP-PAY-07. Confirmed duplicate collection

MP-PAY-08. Incorrect amounts and currency differences

MP-PAY-09. Payment already made by another method

MP-PAY-10. External disputes and avoiding duplicate reimbursement

MP-PAY-11. Other complaints and mixed reasons

MP-PAY-12. Evidence collection and prohibited shortcuts

MP-PAY-13. Approval limits and decision outcomes

MP-PAY-14. Safe transaction retries and audit records

MP-PAY-15. Reason labels used in this test corpus

MP-PAY-16. Worked reconciliation examples

MP-PAY-01. Accepted payment routes and ledger ownership

The fictional checkout supports payment cards through a configured processor, PayPal and a merchant store-credit balance. A particular order records the route actually selected, not every method supported by the store. Mobile-wallet transactions, if included in a future fixture, retain the underlying processor reference and are not treated as an extra independent payment.

A payment record links merchant order ID, provider transaction ID, operation type, amount, currency, source status, event time and funding allocation. A merchant reference helps locate a payment but does not establish settlement. The provider's authenticated response is checked for the relevant financial state.

MaplePaw does not routinely accept informal direct transfers, screenshots as payment, or payment to an employee's account. An exceptional alternative route must have written approval and a merchant ledger entry under MP-PAY-09. Staff must not instruct a customer to pay a second time merely because the first payment has not yet appeared in a local cache.

MP-PAY-02. Authorization, capture and split shipment accounting

An authorization reserves funds or confirms available funding. Capture collects funds against that authorization. The customer may see both a pending authorization and a posted capture, although only the capture constitutes collected payment for this reconciliation. A pending hold must not be counted as collected funds in an overpayment calculation.

For one-time orders, MaplePaw normally authorizes the confirmed total and captures the allocation of each package when it ships. Multiple partial captures may occur for split shipments. The sum of captures must not exceed the confirmed payable amount, and no allocation may be captured twice.

Capture records identify the items and tax or delivery allocations they fund. If the provider does not expose that level of detail, the merchant retains its allocation record alongside the provider transaction. A reused order number does not make two captures valid; each capture must represent a distinct unpaid allocation or a separately consented order.

MP-PAY-03. Pending holds and cancelled orders

When an order is successfully cancelled before capture, MaplePaw requests an authorization void where supported. A funding institution may continue showing a hold after the void request. For test messaging, the merchant uses an expected release range of two to seven business days after a provider-accepted void or authorization expiry event.

If the relevant provider event is absent or its status is uncertain, staff do not present the range as already running. They investigate whether the void was accepted, whether the authorization simply remains active, or whether a capture occurred. If a capture exists, an authorization release alone cannot return the captured funds.

A customer seeing a pending hold and a posted purchase may be experiencing a display overlap rather than a duplicate charge. Support explains both entries and identifies their statuses. If the hold exceeds the fictional range, the case is escalated with the provider reference; the merchant does not promise a bank-controlled release time.

MP-PAY-04. Unrecognized or unauthorized transactions

A customer who denies making or authorizing a payment may provide a redacted transaction reference, amount, currency, date and any known order association. MaplePaw searches its own records and checks whether the entry belongs to a household purchase, a recurring order, another merchant or an unrelated transaction.

Possible explanations are investigated without presuming consent. A prior purchase, authenticated account session, valid delivery address, receipt of goods or a saved funding token does not alone prove authorization of the disputed payment. A delivered parcel can support fulfilment while leaving the authorization question unresolved.

Every explicit authorization denial requires human review. MaplePaw may temporarily stop unfulfilled orders and future recurring attempts associated with the disputed credential while preserving evidence. Staff route account-security concerns to the appropriate team and direct the customer to their payment provider's secure reporting channel where appropriate.

A verified merchant-side mistake is corrected through the supported provider route after reconciliation. Where authorization remains contested, staff assemble factual records and follow the provider's current process. They do not promise that account activity or a tracking number will defeat an unauthorized-payment claim.

MP-PAY-05. Refund not received or credit not processed

Support distinguishes a refund promised, a refund approved, a refund submitted and a refund accepted or completed by the provider. The amount, currency, original transaction, refund ID and event status are checked. If no refund was submitted after an approved eligible remedy, the merchant addresses the processing failure instead of telling the customer to wait for a nonexistent credit.

MP-RET-11 provides the three-business-day submission target and five-to-ten-business-day posting assumption. A posting enquiry begins with the provider-accepted refund date. Where acceptance never occurred, the applicable next step is submission review or failed-refund remediation rather than a posting-delay explanation.

If the provider reports completion and the fictional posting range has expired, MaplePaw supplies the available provider reference and seeks a status investigation. It checks whether the refund went to another original funding allocation in a mixed-payment order. A case reference, courtesy credit or authorization void is not a substitute for the requested cash refund.

A failed or reversed refund requires a new verified plan. Staff must check whether retrying is safe and whether the original provider operation can be queried. An uncertain network response does not justify immediately creating a second refund.

MP-PAY-06. Multiple entries that are not confirmed duplicates

Several entries can arise from a pending hold plus a capture, distinct captures for separate packages, distinct orders, a retry that replaced a failed attempt, or a recurring order near a one-time purchase. Support identifies each operation and links it to an order and funding allocation.

Similar amounts and close timestamps are useful search clues but not sufficient proof of duplication. Two identical purchases may be intentional; two different amounts may still include an overlapping capture. The investigation checks the customer's confirmed orders, shipped allocations and provider settlement status.

A retry can be treated as replacing a failed attempt only when the earlier attempt is confirmed failed, voided or otherwise uncollected. A timeout is an unknown result. If the merchant cannot prove that the earlier operation did not settle, it must query and reconcile before declaring the retry harmless.

MP-PAY-07. Confirmed duplicate collection

A duplicate exists when two or more collected transactions fund the same payable obligation beyond the amount legitimately owed, without a separately confirmed purchase or independent allocation. The merchant preserves both provider references and determines which amount is excess.

For a verified duplicate, MaplePaw refunds the excess collection to the original funding route after checking for earlier credits or external adjustments. It does not require returning correctly supplied goods merely to correct an extra payment. The retained valid payment remains associated with the fulfilled order.

Example: One confirmed order owes CAD 84.00 and two distinct captures of CAD 84.00 both settled for that same complete order. If neither was reversed or refunded and no other valid order exists, the excess is CAD 84.00. One pending CAD 84.00 authorization plus one settled CAD 84.00 capture is not the same fact pattern.

If a separate valid order may exist or settlement status is unclear, the system returns a reconciliation request rather than an automatic duplicate finding. Repeated customer complaints do not replace transaction-level evidence.

MP-PAY-08. Incorrect amounts and currency differences

The expected merchant amount comes from the purchase-time confirmed order or the recurring amount authorized under MP-AUTO-05. It includes accepted discounts, item quantity, approved delivery fee, configured tax and store-credit application. The merchant compares that expected amount with net collected payment, accounting for completed refunds and verified provider reversals.

An unapproved delivery surcharge, omitted accepted discount, incorrect quantity, tax-calculation error in the order fixture or capture exceeding the confirmed amount can support correction. An actual overcollection is refunded in the verified excess amount. Undercollection does not authorize silently taking a new charge; further payment requires a customer-approved transaction.

The funding account may show currency conversion or issuer fees outside MaplePaw's charge. Staff explain the merchant currency and provider amount separately and avoid declaring all differences to be merchant overcharges. If the CAD merchant amount is itself wrong, conversion is not an excuse.

Arithmetic example: Merchandise after discounts is CAD 70.00, disclosed delivery is CAD 6.50, fixture tax is CAD 3.50 and store credit is CAD 10.00. Expected external payment is CAD

70.00. A settled external capture of CAD 76.50 with no other adjustment overcollects CAD 6.50.

MP-PAY-09. Payment already made by another method

A PAYMENT_BY_OTHER_MEANS complaint requires matching the alleged other payment to the same obligation. The customer may provide a redacted receipt, bank transfer reference, amount, currency, date and beneficiary. Support checks whether the merchant actually accepted that route and received cleared funds for the disputed order.

If an exceptional bank transfer was approved in writing and the ledger confirms cleared payment for that order, a later PayPal capture for the same unpaid balance is excess unless a separate allocation or valid new order explains it. MaplePaw corrects the verified excess after reconciliation under MP-PAY-10.

A screenshot alone does not prove clearance or order linkage. A transfer to an unrelated person, a payment for another order, or a promised transfer that failed does not establish payment of this obligation. Conversely, the merchant cannot ignore a verified approved transfer merely because its checkout usually prefers cards or PayPal.

Store credit legitimately applied alongside an external payment is split funding, not necessarily double payment. A gift card or credit must be matched to its ledger allocation. An intentional second order requires its own confirmation, not just a merchant assertion that the other payment probably belongs elsewhere.

MP-PAY-10. External disputes and avoiding duplicate reimbursement

Before executing a financial remedy for a transaction with an external dispute, MaplePaw retrieves the available current dispute status, allowed action and related financial adjustments. It also checks earlier merchant refunds, provider refunds, chargebacks, reversals and store-credit remedies for that specific allocation.

A temporary funding hold, a provisional credit and a final reversal are different events. A held transaction does not itself mean the customer was permanently refunded. Staff preserve the reported state and uncertainty. They must not reduce the customer's confirmed remedy by an unverified provisional credit as if it were final.

If the provider offers a dispute-specific refund or acceptance action, staff use the current supported route after approval. They do not issue an unrelated reimbursement while blindly assuming the dispute will close. The policy does not define which API action is always available; that depends on the live case.

Where a completed merchant refund and a final external credit cover the same loss, a reviewer reconciles the overlap with the provider. MaplePaw does not silently recharge the customer. A disputed credit does not erase documentation of the original fulfilment or billing issue.

MP-PAY-11. Other complaints and mixed reasons

OTHER covers a complaint that does not fit a supported category or lacks enough information to classify. Staff summarize the allegation, identify the requested remedy and ask for the minimum missing facts. They apply a specific policy only when its conditions actually match.

A complaint may involve several reasons. A recurring shipment can be validly created but never delivered; the non-receipt claim remains relevant. A customer can receive goods and still face a duplicate capture. A wrong-product complaint can coexist with a refund that was approved but never submitted.

The system may identify a primary reason for workflow routing and retain secondary issues. It must not discard a payment error because a delivery scan exists or treat every dissatisfaction message as unauthorized payment. Unknown provider reason values are preserved as unknown rather than silently remapped.

MP-PAY-12. Evidence collection and prohibited shortcuts

Relevant evidence includes the original order snapshot, archived product description where applicable, provider transactions, authorization or consent record, shipment allocation, refund record, recurring schedule history and customer communications. Each fact is tied to a specific transaction or obligation.

OCR-derived amounts and dates are checked against the source when confidence is low or a discrepancy matters. A model-generated letter is a summary of evidence, not new evidence. The merchant must not generate a delivery signature, payment receipt or customer agreement that never existed.

Evidence is exported with unrelated personal data redacted. The merchant retains enough transaction linkage to explain the claim, while excluding passwords, one-time codes, card security codes and full funding credentials. Access is limited to staff handling the case.

MP-PAY-13. Approval limits and decision outcomes

A gross proposed monetary remedy of CAD 250.00 or more requires human approval, consistent with MP-RET-15. Explicit authorization denials, disputed settlement status, conflicting payment records, uncertain external credits and unsupported alternative payment destinations require human review even below that amount.

Available recommendation states are request information, investigate internally, propose correction, propose refund, propose replacement where applicable, prepare factual response, or escalate. These are advisory states. An evidence-strength assessment is not a calibrated probability of winning an external case.

A reviewer records the supporting clause IDs, relevant fact references, material uncertainty and reason for action. A low merchant-loss estimate is not permission to ignore a correct billing obligation. Customer history may help find related transactions but cannot substitute for current evidence.

MP-PAY-14. Safe transaction retries and audit records

Before retrying a capture, void or refund after a timeout, MaplePaw queries the original operation using the provider's supported identifiers. If the original result remains unknown, the operation is escalated. Repeating an action without checking can create precisely the duplicate collection this policy is meant to prevent.

For routes supporting idempotency, the merchant preserves the request identifier for a single intended financial operation and follows the provider's documented semantics. A new

intended remedy requires a new recorded decision. Staff do not assume every endpoint accepts the same idempotency header.

The audit record stores the proposed action, approval, request reference, response status, affected amount, operation timestamp and source version. It distinguishes a failed request from a provider-declared failure and from a request whose outcome is unknown. Log entries redact credentials and sensitive payment data.

MP-PAY-15. Reason labels used in this test corpus

The reference guide uses these nine application labels: MERCHANDISE_OR_SERVICE_NOT_RECEIVED, MERCHANDISE_OR_SERVICE_NOT_AS_DESCRIBED, UNAUTHORISED, CREDIT_NOT_PROCESSED, DUPLICATE_TRANSACTION, INCORRECT_AMOUNT, PAYMENT_BY_OTHER_MEANS, CANCELED_RECURRING_BILLING and OTHER.

They are routing labels for the user's test application. This document does not certify that every label is accepted by every current provider endpoint, or that a particular provider uses the same spelling or granularity. Integration code must preserve the actual reason returned by the provider and apply an explicit verified mapping.

Each label selects an investigation topic; it is not a finding. The customer reporting duplicate collection may be looking at a pending hold. The customer reporting cancelled recurring billing may have a shipment order created before cancellation. Those possibilities require facts and the relevant policy, not an automatic rejection.

MP-PAY-16. Worked reconciliation examples

Example A: A customer sees a pending CAD 42.00 authorization and one settled CAD 42.00 capture. The merchant explains the hold under MP-PAY-03 and checks release timing. It does not issue a duplicate-payment refund without evidence of another collected payment.

Example B: Two separate settled captures fund the same CAD 42.00 obligation. No distinct package allocation, other order, completed refund or reversal exists. MP-PAY-07 supports refunding CAD 42.00 excess.

Example C: A CAD 42.00 bank transfer cleared for the same order after written merchant approval, followed by a CAD 42.00 PayPal capture. MP-PAY-09 supports correcting the excess after current external-case reconciliation. Without clearance and order linkage, more information is needed.

Example D: An agent promised a refund twelve business days ago, but no provider refund transaction exists. This is a merchant processing failure under MP-PAY-05, not merely slow bank posting. The recommendation requests approved submission or failed-operation review.